

Bhagavad Gita

English draft

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Chapter 1 - Arjuna Vishada Yoga

1.1 (*Dhritarashtra*)

On the field of dharma, at Kurukshetra, gathered and eager for battle—what did my men and the Pandavas do, O Sanjaya?

1.2 (*Sanjaya*)

Then, seeing the Pandava army drawn up in formation, King Duryodhana approached his teacher and spoke these words.

1.3 (*Sanjaya*)

Behold, O teacher, this great army of the sons of Pandu, arrayed by your skilled disciple, the son of Drupada.

1.4 (*Sanjaya*)

Here are heroes, mighty archers, equal in battle to Bhima and Arjuna: Yuyudhana, Virata, and Drupada, the great chariot-warrior.

1.5 (*Sanjaya*)

Dhrishtaketu, Chekitana, and the valiant king of Kashi; Purujit, Kuntibhoja, and Shaibya, the foremost of men.

1.6 (*Sanjaya*)

The valiant Yudhamanyu and the courageous Uttamauja, Saubhadra and the sons of Draupadi—all great chariot-warriors.

1.7 (*Sanjaya*)

Know too, O best of the twice-born, those who are foremost among us, the leaders of my army; these I name to you.

1.8 (*Sanjaya*)

Yourself, and Bhishma, Karna, and Kripa, ever victorious in battle; Ashvatthama, Vikarna, and Saumadatti as well.

1.9 (*Sanjaya*)

And many other heroes, who have staked their lives for my sake, bearing varied weapons—all skilled in war.

1.10 (*Sanjaya*)

Our force, guarded by Bhishma, is insufficient; but their force, guarded by Bhima, is sufficient.

1.11 (*Sanjaya*)

Therefore, stationed in your respective positions throughout the divisions, let all of you guard Bhishma above all.

1.12 (*Sanjaya*)

To cheer him, the aged Kuru, the mighty grandsire, roared like a lion and loudly blew his conch.

1.13 (*Sanjaya*)

Then conches, drums, kettledrums, and horns suddenly sounded, and the noise was tumultuous.

1.14 (*Sanjaya*)

Then, stationed in their great chariot yoked with white horses, Madhava and the Pandava blew their divine conches.

1.15 (*Sanjaya*)

Hrishikesha blew the Panchajanya, Dhananjaya the Devadatta, and Vrikodara, of mighty deeds, blew the great conch Paundra.

1.16 (*Sanjaya*)

King Yudhishtira, son of Kunti, blew the Anantavijaya; Nakula and Sahadeva, the Sughosha and the Manipushpaka.

1.17 (*Sanjaya*)

The king of Kashi, supreme archer, and Shikhandin, the great chariot-warrior; Dhrishtadyumna, Virata, and the unconquered Satyaki.

1.18 (*Sanjaya*)

Drupada and the sons of Draupadi, and the strong-armed son of Subhadra—each on every side blew his conch, O lord of the earth.

1.19 (*Sanjaya*)

That tumultuous din, resounding through sky and earth, pierced the hearts of Dhritarashtra's sons.

1.20 (*Sanjaya*)

Then, seeing Dhritarashtra's sons arrayed, as the clash of weapons was about to begin, the Pandava whose banner bore the monkey took up his bow

1.21 (*Arjuna*)

and spoke these words to Hrishikesha, O king: "O Acyuta, place my chariot between the two armies,

1.22 (*Arjuna*)

that I may look upon these men standing eager to fight, with whom I must contend in this work of battle.

1.23 (*Arjuna*)

I see them gathered here, ready to fight, seeking to please in battle the evil-minded son of Dhritarashtra.

1.24 (*Sanjaya*)

Thus addressed by Gudakesha, O Bharata, Hrishikesha placed that finest of chariots between the two armies,

1.25 (*Sanjaya*)

before Bhishma and Drona and all the rulers of the earth, and said: "O Partha, behold these Kurus gathered here."

1.26 (*Sanjaya*)

There Partha saw, standing before him, fathers and grandfathers, teachers, uncles, brothers, sons, grandsons, and friends as well;

1.27 (*Sanjaya*)

fathers-in-law and companions too, in both armies. Seeing all these kinsmen arrayed,

1.28 (*Arjuna*)

the son of Kunti was overcome with deep compassion, and in sorrow he said:

"Seeing my own people, Krishna, gathered here eager to fight,

1.29 (*Arjuna*)

my limbs give way and my mouth goes dry; my body trembles and my hair stands on end.

1.30 (*Arjuna*)

The Gandiva slips from my hand, and my skin burns all over; I cannot stand steady, and my mind seems to reel.

1.31 (*Arjuna*)

And I see adverse omens, O Keshava; I foresee no good in killing my own people in battle.

1.32 (*Arjuna*)

I long for no victory, Krishna, nor kingdom, nor pleasures. What use is a kingdom to us, Govinda, or enjoyments, or even life?

1.33 (*Arjuna*)

Those for whose sake we would want kingdom, enjoyments, and pleasures stand here in battle, having renounced their lives and wealth:

1.34 (*Arjuna*)

teachers, fathers, sons, and grandfathers; uncles, fathers-in-law, grandsons, brothers-in-law, and other kinsmen.

1.35 (*Arjuna*)

These I would not wish to kill, O Madhusudana, even if killed myself—not even for the sovereignty of the three worlds, much less for the earth.

1.36 (*Arjuna*)

What joy would be ours, O Janardana, in killing Dhritarashtra's sons? Only sin would fall upon us were we to kill these aggressors.

1.37 (*Arjuna*)

So we ought not to kill Dhritarashtra's sons, our own kinsmen; for how could we be happy, O Madhava, after killing our own people?

1.38 (*Arjuna*)

Even if these men, their minds overcome by greed, see no fault in the ruin of a family and no crime in the betrayal of friends,

1.39 (*Arjuna*)

how should we not know to turn back from this sin, O Janardana, we who clearly see the fault in the ruin of a family?

1.40 (*Arjuna*)

When a family is ruined, its ancient dharmas perish; and when dharma perishes, adharma overcomes the whole family.

1.41 (*Arjuna*)

When adharma prevails, O Krishna, the women of the family are corrupted; and when the women are corrupted, O Varshneya, there arises confusion of order.

1.42 (*Arjuna*)

This confusion brings only hell for the family and for those who ruin it; their ancestors fall, deprived of the offerings of rice and water.

1.43 (*Arjuna*)

By these faults of the family-destroyers, which bring about confusion of varna, the eternal dharmas of community and family are undone.

1.44 (*Arjuna*)

And we have heard, O Janardana, that for those whose family dharmas are destroyed, a dwelling in hell is assured.

1.45 (*Arjuna*)

Alas, we are bent on committing a great sin: out of greed for the pleasures of a kingdom, we are prepared to kill our own people.

1.46 (*Arjuna*)

It would be better for me if Dhritarashtra's sons, weapons in hand, were to kill me unresisting and unarmed in the battle.

1.47 (*Sanjaya*)

Having spoken thus on the field of battle, Arjuna sank down upon the seat of the chariot, casting away his bow and arrows, his mind stricken

with grief.

Chapter 2 - Sankhya Yoga

2.1 (*Sanjaya*)

Seeing him thus overcome by compassion, his eyes troubled and brimming with tears, Madhusudana spoke these words to the despondent Arjuna.

2.2 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Whence has this faintness come upon you in the hour of crisis, Arjuna? It is ignoble, unworthy of an honorable man, and leads neither to heaven nor to fame.

2.3 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Do not give way to weakness, Partha; it does not become you. Cast off this base faint-heartedness and rise up, scorcher of foes.

2.4 (*Arjuna*)

How, O Madhusudana, shall I fight back with arrows against Bhishma and Drona, who are worthy of reverence, O destroyer of enemies?

2.5 (*Arjuna*)

Better to live in this world on alms than to kill these noble teachers. Were I to kill these teachers, though they seek their own gain, the very pleasures I enjoyed would be smeared with blood.

2.6 (*Arjuna*)

And we do not know which is better for us—that we should conquer them, or that they should conquer us; for the sons of Dhritarashtra stand before us, and having killed them we would have no wish to live.

2.7 (*Arjuna*)

My very being is stricken with the weakness of pity, my mind bewildered about my dharma. I ask you: tell me plainly what is best. I am your pupil; I take refuge in you—instruct me.

2.8 (*Arjuna*)

For I see nothing that could drive away the grief withering my senses,

even were I to win unrivaled and prosperous dominion on earth, or lordship over the gods.

2.9 (*Sanjaya*)

Having spoken thus to Hrishikesha, Gudakesha, scorcher of foes, said to Govinda, “I will not fight,” and fell silent.

2.10 (*Sanjaya*)

To him, despondent there between the two armies, Hrishikesha spoke, as if smiling, O Bharata, these words:

2.11 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

You grieve for those who should not be grieved for, yet you speak words of wisdom. The wise grieve neither for the dead nor for the living.

2.12 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Never was there a time when I was not, nor you, nor these lords of men; nor shall any of us cease to be hereafter.

2.13 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

As the embodied self passes, within this body, through childhood, youth, and age, so it passes to another body; the steady are not bewildered by this.

2.14 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

The contacts of the senses with their objects, O son of Kunti, bring cold and heat, pleasure and pain; they come and go and do not last. Endure them, O Bharata.

2.15 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

The one whom these do not trouble, O best of men, who is steady, alike in pain and pleasure—he is fit for immortality.

2.16 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Of the unreal there is no being; of the real there is no ceasing to be. The seers of truth have discerned the conclusion of both.

2.17 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Know that to be indestructible by which all this is pervaded; none can

bring about the destruction of this imperishable one.

2.18 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

These bodies of the eternal embodied self are said to have an end, but the self itself is indestructible and beyond measure; therefore fight, O Bharata.

2.19 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

He who thinks it the slayer, and he who thinks it slain—neither understands; it neither slays nor is slain.

2.20 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

It is never born and never dies; having once been, it never ceases to be. Unborn, eternal, everlasting, primeval, it is not killed when the body is killed.

2.21 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

He who knows it as indestructible, eternal, unborn, and unchanging—how can such a person kill, or cause to be killed, and whom, O Partha?

2.22 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

As a person casts off worn-out clothes and puts on others that are new, so the embodied self casts off worn-out bodies and takes on others that are new.

2.23 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Weapons do not cut it, fire does not burn it; water does not wet it, nor does wind dry it.

2.24 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

It cannot be cut, burned, wetted, or dried; it is eternal, all-pervading, firm, unmoving, and primeval.

2.25 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

It is called unmanifest, unthinkable, and unchanging; therefore, knowing it to be such, you ought not to grieve.

2.26 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

And even if you suppose it to be constantly born and constantly dying, even then, O mighty-armed one, you ought not to grieve.

2.27 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

For one who is born, death is certain; for one who dies, birth is certain. Therefore you ought not to grieve over what cannot be avoided.

2.28 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Beings are unmanifest in their beginnings, manifest in the middle, and unmanifest again at their end, O Bharata. What occasion for lament is there in this?

2.29 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

One sees it as a wonder, another speaks of it as a wonder, another hears of it as a wonder; yet even having heard, no one truly knows it.

2.30 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

The embodied self within the body of every being is forever beyond harm, O Bharata; therefore you ought not to grieve for any being.

2.31 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Considering, too, your own dharma, you ought not to waver; for a kshatriya there is no greater good than a battle in accord with dharma.

2.32 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Happy the kshatriyas, O Partha, who meet with such a battle, come of itself like an open gate to heaven.

2.33 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

But if you will not wage this rightful battle, then, forsaking your own dharma and your honor, you will fall into sin.

2.34 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

People will tell of your lasting disgrace; and for one who has been honored, disgrace is worse than death.

2.35 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

The great chariot-warriors will think you withdrew from the battle out of fear, and you will fall in the esteem of those who held you high.

2.36 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Your enemies will speak many unseemly words, scorning your strength. What could be more painful than that?

2.37 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Slain, you will gain heaven; victorious, you will enjoy the earth. Therefore rise up, O son of Kunti, resolved to fight.

2.38 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Holding pleasure and pain alike, gain and loss, victory and defeat, gird yourself for battle; thus you will incur no sin.

2.39 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

This understanding has been declared to you according to Sankhya; now hear it as it bears on yoga. Yoked with this understanding, O Partha, you will cast off the bondage of karma.

2.40 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

On this path no effort is lost and no harm is done; even a little of this dharma protects one from great fear.

2.41 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Here there is but one resolute understanding, O joy of the Kurus; but the thoughts of the irresolute are many-branched and endless.

2.42 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

This flowery speech is uttered by the unwise, who delight in the letter of the Vedas, O Partha, and declare there is nothing more;

2.43 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

full of desire and intent on heaven, they offer rites that yield rebirth as the fruit of action, abounding in special ceremonies aimed at enjoyment and power.

2.44 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

For those attached to enjoyment and power, whose minds are carried away by such talk, no resolute understanding is established in concentration.

2.45 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

The Vedas treat of the three gunas; be free of the three gunas, O Arjuna—beyond the pairs of opposites, ever poised in purity, indifferent to gain and safety, and possessed of the self.

2.46 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

As much use as there is in a well when water floods on every side, so much use is there in all the Vedas for the brahmin who knows.

2.47 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Your right is to action alone, never to its fruits. Let not the fruits of action be your motive, nor let attachment to inaction take hold in you.

2.48 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Established in yoga, perform your actions, abandoning attachment, O Dhananjaya, even-minded in success and failure; this evenness of mind is called yoga.

2.49 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Action is far inferior to the yoga of understanding, O Dhananjaya; take refuge in understanding. Pitiably are those who act for the sake of fruits.

2.50 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

One yoked in understanding casts off here both good and evil deeds; therefore devote yourself to yoga—yoga is skill in action.

2.51 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

The wise, yoked in understanding, renounce the fruit born of action and, freed from the bondage of birth, reach the state beyond all ills.

2.52 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

When your understanding has crossed beyond the thicket of delusion, then you will grow indifferent to what is yet to be heard and what has been heard.

2.53 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

When your understanding, once bewildered by scriptural lore, stands unmoving and steady in concentration, then you will attain yoga.

2.54 (*Arjuna*)

What is the mark of one whose wisdom is steady, settled in concentration, O Keshava? How does the steady-minded one speak, how sit, how move?

2.55 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

When a person puts away all the desires that enter the mind, O Partha, and is content within himself by himself, then he is called steady in wisdom.

2.56 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

He whose mind is untroubled in sorrows and free of craving amid pleasures, gone beyond longing, fear, and anger, is called a sage of steady mind.

2.57 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

He who is unattached on every side, who neither delights nor recoils at meeting good or ill—his wisdom stands firm.

2.58 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

And when, like a tortoise drawing in its limbs, he withdraws his senses entirely from their objects, his wisdom stands firm.

2.59 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

The objects of sense fall away from the embodied one who abstains, though a taste for them remains; even that taste falls away when he sees the Supreme.

2.60 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

For even in one who strives, O son of Kunti, who sees clearly, the turbulent senses carry off the mind by force.

2.61 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Holding all these in check, let him sit yoked, intent on me; for one whose senses are mastered, wisdom stands firm.

2.62 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

In a person who dwells on the objects of sense, attachment to them is born; from attachment springs desire, and from desire, anger.

2.63 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

From anger comes delusion; from delusion, the wandering of memory; from the loss of memory, the ruin of understanding; and from the ruin of understanding, the person perishes.

2.64 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

But one who moves among the objects of sense with senses freed from attachment and aversion, mastered and under his own control, attains serenity.

2.65 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

In serenity all his sorrows are dissolved; for the mind of the serene soon grows steady.

2.66 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

For the unsteady there is no understanding, and for the unsteady, no meditation; without meditation there is no peace, and for one without peace, how can there be happiness?

2.67 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

For when the mind runs after the roving senses, it carries off one's wisdom as the wind carries off a boat upon the water.

2.68 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Therefore, O mighty-armed one, he whose senses are wholly withdrawn from their objects—his wisdom stands firm.

2.69 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

What is night for all beings is the waking of the disciplined one; where beings are awake, there it is night for the sage who sees.

2.70 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

As the waters flow into the ocean, which fills yet stays unmoved, so all desires flow into him who attains peace—not the one who hankers

after desires.

2.71 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

The person who, abandoning all desires, moves about free of longing, without ‘mine’ and without ego, attains peace.

2.72 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

This is the state of Brahman, O Partha; reaching it, one is no longer deluded. Established in it even at the hour of death, one attains the nirvana of Brahman.

Chapter 3 - Karma Yoga

3.1 (*Arjuna*)

Janardana, if you hold understanding to be superior to action, then why, Keshava, do you urge me to this terrible deed?

3.2 (*Arjuna*)

With these seemingly conflicting words you bewilder my understanding. Tell me decisively the one thing by which I may reach the highest good.

3.3 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

In this world, O blameless one, a twofold path was taught by me of old: the yoga of knowledge for the followers of Sankhya, and the yoga of action for the yogins.

3.4 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Not by abstaining from actions does a person attain freedom from action, nor by renunciation alone does one reach perfection.

3.5 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

For no one ever remains, even for a moment, without performing action; everyone is driven to act, helpless, by the gunas born of prakriti.

3.6 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

One who restrains the organs of action yet sits brooding in the mind on the objects of sense, his self deluded, is called a hypocrite.

3.7 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

But one who, controlling the senses with the mind, undertakes through the organs of action the yoga of action, unattached—he excels, O Arjuna.

3.8 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Perform your appointed action, for action is better than inaction; even the upkeep of your body could not be accomplished by inaction.

3.9 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

This world is bound by action, except when action is done as yajna; therefore, O son of Kunti, perform your action for that end, free from attachment.

3.10 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Having created humankind together with yajna, Prajapati said of old: “By this you shall increase; let it be the cow that grants your desires.

3.11 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

By this nourish the gods, and let the gods nourish you; nourishing one another, you shall attain the highest good.

3.12 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Nourished by yajna, the gods will grant you the enjoyments you desire; but one who enjoys their gifts without offering back to them is nothing but a thief.

3.13 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

The good, who eat the remnants of yajna, are freed from all sins; but the wicked, who cook only for themselves, eat sin.

3.14 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

From food beings come to be; from rain comes food; from yajna comes rain; and yajna is born of action.

3.15 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Know that action springs from Brahman, and Brahman from the imperishable; therefore the all-pervading Brahman is ever present in yajna.

3.16 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

He who does not follow here the wheel thus set in motion, malicious and delighting in the senses, lives in vain, O Partha.

3.17 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

But for the one who delights in the self alone, content with the self and satisfied in the self, there is nothing that must be done.

3.18 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

For him there is no purpose in action done or left undone here, nor

does he depend on any being for any end.

3.19 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Therefore, ever unattached, perform the action that must be done; for the person who works unattached attains the highest.

3.20 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

It was by action alone that Janaka and others attained perfection; and with an eye to the holding-together of the world, you too should act.

3.21 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Whatever the eminent person does, that the rest will do; whatever standard he sets, the world follows it.

3.22 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

There is nothing in the three worlds I need to do, O Partha, nor anything unattained that I must gain; yet I remain engaged in action.

3.23 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

For if I did not remain ever tireless in action, O Partha, people everywhere would follow my path.

3.24 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

These worlds would fall to ruin if I did not perform action; I would be the maker of confusion and would destroy these creatures.

3.25 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

As the ignorant act with attachment to action, O Bharata, so should the wise act, but unattached, seeking the welfare of the world.

3.26 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Let the wise not unsettle the minds of the ignorant who are attached to action; acting with discipline, he should make all actions attractive to them.

3.27 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Actions are in every way performed by the gunas of prakriti; one whose mind is deluded by ego thinks, "I am the doer."

3.28 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

But one who knows the truth, O mighty-armed one, about the divisions of guna and action is not bound, knowing that it is the gunas that act among the gunas.

3.29 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Those deluded by the gunas of prakriti grow attached to the actions of the gunas; let the one who knows the whole not unsettle the dull who do not.

3.30 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Surrendering all actions to me, with mind fixed on the self, free of longing and of any sense of ‘mine,’ fight, your fever gone.

3.31 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Those who constantly follow this teaching of mine, full of faith and free from cavil, are released even from their karma.

3.32 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

But those who, finding fault, do not follow this teaching of mine—know them to be deluded in all knowledge, mindless, and lost.

3.33 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Even the wise act according to their own nature; beings follow their nature—what can restraint accomplish?

3.34 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

In each sense, attraction and aversion are seated toward its object; let no one fall under their power, for they are one’s enemies.

3.35 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Better one’s own dharma, imperfectly done, than another’s dharma well performed. Better to die in one’s own dharma; another’s dharma brings danger.

3.36 (*Arjuna*)

Then by what is a person driven to do evil, O Varshneya, even against his will, as if compelled by force?

3.37 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

It is desire, it is anger, born of the guna of rajas— all-devouring, deeply harmful; know it here to be the enemy.

3.38 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

As fire is veiled by smoke, a mirror by dust, and an embryo by the womb, so is this veiled by that.

3.39 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Knowledge is veiled, O son of Kunti, by this constant enemy of the wise—desire, an insatiable fire.

3.40 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

The senses, the mind, and the understanding are said to be its seat; through these it veils knowledge and deludes the embodied one.

3.41 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Therefore, O best of the Bharatas, first master your senses, then strike down this evil thing, the destroyer of knowledge and discernment.

3.42 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

The senses, they say, are high; higher than the senses is the mind; higher than the mind is the understanding; and higher than the understanding is the self.

3.43 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Thus knowing it to be higher than the understanding, and steadying the self by the self, slay the enemy, O mighty-armed one, in the form of desire, so hard to subdue.

Chapter 4 - Jnana-Karma-Sannyasa Yoga

4.1 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

I taught this imperishable yoga to Vivasvan; Vivasvan told it to Manu, and Manu told it to Ikshvaku.

4.2 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Thus handed down in succession, the royal sages knew it; but over the long course of time, O scorcher of foes, this yoga was lost here on earth.

4.3 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

It is this very same ancient yoga that I have declared to you today, for you are my devotee and my friend; for this is the supreme secret.

4.4 (*Arjuna*)

Your birth was later, the birth of Vivasvan earlier; how then am I to understand that you taught it in the beginning?

4.5 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Many births of mine have passed, and yours as well, O Arjuna; I know them all, but you do not, O scorcher of foes.

4.6 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Though I am unborn and imperishable, and the lord of beings, yet, governing my own prakriti, I come into being through my own maya.

4.7 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Whenever dharma declines, O Bharata, and adharma rises up, then I send forth myself.

4.8 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

For the protection of the good and the destruction of the wicked, and to set dharma firmly in place, I come into being age after age.

4.9 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

He who truly knows my divine birth and action, on leaving the body is not born again but comes to me, Arjuna.

4.10 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Freed from passion, fear, and anger, filled with me and taking refuge in me, many, purified by the austerity of knowledge, have attained my state of being.

4.11 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

As they approach me, so do I receive them; people follow my path in every way, O Partha.

4.12 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Desiring success in their works, people here worship the gods; for in the human world success born of action comes quickly.

4.13 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

The four varnas were brought forth by me, apportioned by guna and action. Though I am their maker, know me as the one who does not act, the changeless.

4.14 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Actions do not taint me, nor do I crave the fruits of action; one who knows me thus is not bound by actions.

4.15 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Knowing this, the ancient seekers of liberation also performed action; therefore do action, as the ancients did of old.

4.16 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

What is action? What is inaction? On this even the wise are bewildered. I shall declare to you the action by knowing which you will be freed from ill.

4.17 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

One must understand action, and must understand wrong action, and must understand inaction too; deep is the way of karma.

4.18 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

He who sees inaction in action, and action in inaction, is wise among men; he is disciplined, a doer of every action.

4.19 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

He whose every undertaking is free of desire and design, whose actions are burned up in the fire of knowledge—him the wise call learned.

4.20 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Having given up attachment to the fruits of action, ever content and dependent on nothing, he does nothing at all, even while fully engaged in action.

4.21 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Free of expectation, mind and self controlled, abandoning all possessions, he performs action with the body alone and incurs no fault.

4.22 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Content with whatever comes unsought, beyond the pairs of opposites, free of envy, even in success and failure, he is not bound even when he acts.

4.23 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

For one who is unattached and free, whose mind is settled in knowledge, who acts as yajna—his action dissolves entirely.

4.24 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

The act of offering is Brahman, the oblation is Brahman, poured by Brahman into the fire of Brahman; Brahman is what he reaches who is absorbed in the action that is Brahman.

4.25 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Some yogins offer sacrifice to the gods alone; others offer the very sacrifice as an offering into the fire of Brahman.

4.26 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Some offer hearing and the other senses into the fires of restraint; others offer sound and the other objects of sense into the fires of the senses.

4.27 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

And others offer all the workings of the senses and the workings of the breath into the fire of self-control, kindled by knowledge.

4.28 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Others again make their sacrifice with wealth, with austerity, with yoga, and with study and knowledge—ascetics of keen vows.

4.29 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Others offer the outgoing breath into the incoming, and the incoming into the outgoing, restraining the course of both, intent on breath-control;

4.30 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

and others, of measured diet, offer the breaths into the breaths. All these know what sacrifice is, and by sacrifice their faults are wiped away.

4.31 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Those who eat the nectar left from yajna go to the eternal Brahman. This world is not for the one who offers no sacrifice—how then the next, O best of the Kurus?

4.32 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Thus sacrifices of many kinds are spread out before Brahman. Know them all to be born of action; knowing this, you will be freed.

4.33 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Better than any sacrifice of goods is the sacrifice of knowledge, O scorcher of foes; for all action, without exception, culminates in knowledge, O Partha.

4.34 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Learn this by reverence, by inquiry, and by service; the knowers who see the truth will impart that knowledge to you.

4.35 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Knowing it, O Pandava, you will not fall again into such delusion; by it you will see all beings, without exception, within yourself, and then within me.

4.36 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Even if you were the worst sinner among all sinners, you would cross over all wrongdoing by the boat of knowledge alone.

4.37 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

As a kindled fire turns its fuel to ashes, O Arjuna, so the fire of knowledge turns all karma to ashes.

4.38 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

There is no purifier here equal to knowledge; one perfected in yoga finds it of itself, in time, within the self.

4.39 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

The one full of faith, intent on it, his senses mastered, attains knowledge; and having attained knowledge, he soon reaches supreme peace.

4.40 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

But the ignorant and faithless, the doubting self, comes to ruin; neither this world nor the next nor any happiness is for the doubting self.

4.41 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Actions do not bind the one who has renounced action through yoga, whose doubts are cut away by knowledge, who is possessed of the self, O Dhananjaya.

4.42 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Therefore, with the sword of knowledge cut away this doubt in your heart, born of ignorance; take up yoga and rise, O Bharata.

Chapter 5 - Sannyasa Yoga

5.1 (*Arjuna*)

O Krishna, you praise the renunciation of actions, and again yoga; tell me for certain which of the two is better.

5.2 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Both renunciation and the yoga of action lead to the highest good; but of the two, the yoga of action excels the renunciation of action.

5.3 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Know him to be a constant renunciant who neither hates nor desires; free of the pairs of opposites, O mighty-armed one, he is released from bondage with ease.

5.4 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

It is the childish, not the wise, who speak of Sankhya and yoga as different; one rightly established in even one of them gains the fruit of both.

5.5 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

The state reached by Sankhya is reached by yoga as well; he who sees Sankhya and yoga as one truly sees.

5.6 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

But renunciation is hard to attain without yoga, O mighty-armed one; the sage yoked in yoga soon reaches Brahman.

5.7 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Yoked in yoga, his self purified, self-mastered, his senses subdued, his self become the self of all beings—he is not tainted even while acting.

5.8 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

“I do nothing at all,” the disciplined knower of truth would hold, even while seeing, hearing, touching, smelling, eating, moving, sleeping, breathing,

5.9 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

speaking, releasing, grasping, opening and closing the eyes—convinced that it is only the senses moving among the objects of sense.

5.10 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

One who acts, offering his actions to Brahman and abandoning attachment, is untouched by sin, as a lotus leaf by water.

5.11 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

With body, mind, understanding, and the senses alone, the yogins act, abandoning attachment, for the purifying of the self.

5.12 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

The disciplined one, abandoning the fruit of action, attains lasting peace; the undisciplined, attached to the fruit through desire, is bound.

5.13 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Renouncing all actions with the mind, the embodied one rests at ease, in command, in the city of nine gates, neither acting nor causing action.

5.14 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

The Lord creates for the world neither agency nor actions, nor the joining of action to its fruit; it is inherent nature that unfolds.

5.15 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

The all-pervading Lord takes on no one's sin or merit; knowledge is veiled by ignorance, and by this beings are deluded.

5.16 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

But for those in whom that ignorance is destroyed by knowledge of the self, knowledge, like the sun, lights up the Supreme.

5.17 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

With understanding fixed on it, their self set on it, devoted to it, intent on it as their goal, they go where there is no return, their faults washed away by knowledge.

5.18 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

On a learned and humble brahmin, on a cow, an elephant, a dog, and an outcaste, the wise look with an equal eye.

5.19 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Even here rebirth is overcome by those whose minds rest in equanimity; for Brahman is flawless and the same in all, and so they are established in Brahman.

5.20 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Neither rejoicing at the pleasant nor recoiling at the unpleasant, steady of understanding and unbewildered, the knower of Brahman is established in Brahman.

5.21 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

With the self unattached to outward contacts, he finds the happiness that is in the self; his self yoked in the yoga of Brahman, he attains unending happiness.

5.22 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

For the pleasures born of contact are wombs of suffering; they have a beginning and an end, O son of Kunti, and the wise take no delight in them.

5.23 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

He who can withstand, even here, before he is freed from the body, the force born of desire and anger—he is disciplined, he is a happy man.

5.24 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

He whose happiness is within, whose delight is within, whose light too is within—that yogin, having become Brahman, attains the nirvana of Brahman.

5.25 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

The seers whose sins are spent, whose doubts are cut away, who are self-mastered and rejoice in the welfare of all beings, attain the nirvana of Brahman.

5.26 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

For ascetics freed from desire and anger, their minds controlled, who have known the self, the nirvana of Brahman lies near on every side.

5.27 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Shutting out the outward contacts, fixing the gaze between the brows, making the inward and outward breaths even as they move through the nostrils,

5.28 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

the sage who has mastered his senses, mind, and understanding, intent on liberation, freed of desire, fear, and anger, is forever free.

5.29 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Knowing me as the enjoyer of sacrifices and austerities, the great lord of all the worlds, the friend of every being, he attains peace.

Chapter 6 - Atma-Samyama Yoga

6.1 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

He who performs the action that ought to be done, not depending on its fruit, is a renunciant and a yogin—not the one who lights no fire and does no rite.

6.2 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Know that what they call renunciation is yoga, O Pandava; for none becomes a yogin without renouncing self-will.

6.3 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

For the sage who seeks to rise to yoga, action is said to be the means; for one who has risen to yoga, stillness is said to be the means.

6.4 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

When one is attached neither to the objects of sense nor to actions, having renounced all self-will, then one is said to have risen to yoga.

6.5 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Let one lift oneself by oneself; let one not drag oneself down. For oneself alone is one's friend, and oneself alone one's enemy.

6.6 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

For one who has conquered himself by himself, the self is a friend to the self; but for one who has not mastered himself, the self stays hostile, like an enemy.

6.7 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

For one who has mastered himself and is at peace, the supreme Atman stays steady, alike in cold and heat, pleasure and pain, honor and dishonor.

6.8 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

The yogin content in knowledge and realization, unwavering, his senses subdued, to whom a clod, a stone, and gold are alike, is said to be yoked.

6.9 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

He who is even-minded toward well-wisher, friend, and foe, toward the neutral and the mediator, toward the hateful and the kinsman, and toward the good and the wicked alike, stands supreme.

6.10 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Let the yogin discipline himself constantly, staying in solitude, alone, his mind and self controlled, free of longing and of possessions.

6.11 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Having set up a firm seat for himself in a clean place, neither too high nor too low, covered with cloth, deerskin, and kusha grass,

6.12 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

there, making the mind one-pointed, the workings of mind and senses checked, seated on that seat, let him practice yoga to purify the self.

6.13 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Holding body, head, and neck erect and still, steady, gazing at the tip of his own nose without looking about,

6.14 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

his mind serene and free of fear, firm in the vow of celibacy, the mind controlled and thought fixed on me, let him sit, yoked, intent on me.

6.15 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Thus ever disciplining himself, the yogin of controlled mind attains the peace that culminates in nirvana and abides in me.

6.16 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Yoga is not for one who eats too much, nor for one who eats nothing at all, nor for one given to too much sleep, nor for one always awake, Arjuna.

6.17 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

For one measured in food and recreation, measured in his actions, measured in sleep and waking, yoga becomes the destroyer of sorrow.

6.18 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

When the disciplined mind comes to rest in the self alone, free of longing for any desire, then one is said to be yoked.

6.19 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

As a lamp in a windless place does not flicker—such is the image of the yogin of controlled mind, practicing the yoga of the self.

6.20 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

When the mind, restrained by the practice of yoga, comes to rest, and seeing the self by the self, one is content within the self;

6.21 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

when one knows that boundless happiness, grasped by the understanding and beyond the senses, and, established in it, never strays from the truth;

6.22 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

and, having gained it, counts no other gain greater—established in it, he is unshaken even by the heaviest sorrow:

6.23 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

let it be known that this severance of all union with sorrow is what is called yoga; that yoga is to be practiced with resolve and an undismayed mind.

6.24 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Abandoning without remainder all desires born of self-will, restraining the whole throng of senses on every side by the mind alone,

6.25 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

little by little let him grow still, the understanding held firm; fixing the mind on the self, let him think of nothing at all.

6.26 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Wherever the restless, unsteady mind wanders off, from there let him rein it back under the control of the self.

6.27 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

For supreme happiness comes to the yogin whose mind is at peace,

whose passion is stilled, who is free of taint and has become Brahman.

6.28 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Thus ever disciplining himself, the yogin, freed of taint, easily attains the boundless happiness of contact with Brahman.

6.29 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

His self yoked in yoga, he sees the self present in all beings and all beings in the self, seeing the same everywhere.

6.30 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

For one who sees me everywhere and sees all things in me, I am not lost to him, nor is he lost to me.

6.31 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

The yogin who, established in oneness, worships me as dwelling in all beings abides in me, in whatever way he lives.

6.32 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

He who sees by analogy with himself the same everywhere, Arjuna, whether in pleasure or in pain, is held to be the highest yogin.

6.33 (*Arjuna*)

This yoga of evenness you have taught, O Madhusudana, I do not see how it can stand firm, because the mind is so restless.

6.34 (*Arjuna*)

For the mind is restless, Krishna—turbulent, strong, and unyielding; to restrain it, I think, is as hard as to restrain the wind.

6.35 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

No doubt, O mighty-armed one, the mind is hard to restrain and restless; but by practice, O son of Kunti, and by dispassion it is held in check.

6.36 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Yoga is hard to reach, I agree, for one whose self is unrestrained; but for one who strives, self-controlled, it can be attained by the right means.

6.37 (*Arjuna*)

One of faith who does not strive, whose mind has strayed from yoga and failed to reach its perfection—what end does he meet, O Krishna?

6.38 (*Arjuna*)

Fallen from both, does he not perish like a scattered cloud, without support, O mighty-armed one, bewildered on the path of Brahman?

6.39 (*Arjuna*)

You are fit, O Krishna, to dispel this doubt of mine completely; for none but you can be found to remove it.

6.40 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

O Partha, neither here nor hereafter is there ruin for him; for no one who does good, my friend, ever comes to a bad end.

6.41 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Having reached the worlds of those who do right and dwelt there countless years, the one fallen from yoga is born in the house of the pure and prosperous;

6.42 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

or else he is born into a family of wise yogins—though a birth like this is harder still to win in this world.

6.43 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

There he regains the union of understanding gained in his former body, and from there strives once more toward perfection, O joy of the Kurus.

6.44 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

By that very former practice he is carried onward, even against his will; even wishing to know yoga, he passes beyond the Brahman of mere words.

6.45 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

But the yogin who strives with effort, cleansed of all faults, perfected through many births, then reaches the supreme goal.

6.46 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

The yogin is greater than the ascetics, greater, it is held, than the men of knowledge, and greater than the men of action; therefore become a yogin, Arjuna.

6.47 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

And of all yogins, the one who, full of faith, worships me with his inmost self drawn to me—him I hold to be the most deeply yoked.

Chapter 7 - Jnana-Vijnana Yoga

7.1 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

With your mind clinging to me, O Partha, practicing yoga and taking refuge in me, hear how you shall know me fully and beyond doubt.

7.2 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

I shall declare to you in full this knowledge together with its realization; once you know it, nothing further remains to be known here.

7.3 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Among thousands of people, scarcely one strives for perfection; and of those who strive and succeed, scarcely one knows me in truth.

7.4 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Earth, water, fire, air, ether, mind, understanding, and ego—so is my prakriti divided eightfold.

7.5 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

This is my lower nature; but know my other nature, the higher, O mighty-armed one—the living principle by which this world is sustained.

7.6 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Know that all beings have their womb in these; I am the origin of the whole universe, and its dissolution as well.

7.7 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

There is nothing higher than me, O Dhananjaya; on me all this is strung, like rows of gems upon a thread.

7.8 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

I am the taste in water, O son of Kunti, the light in moon and sun, the syllable Om in all the Vedas, the sound in space, the manhood in men.

7.9 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

I am the pure fragrance in the earth and the brightness in fire; I am

the life in all beings and the austerity in ascetics.

7.10 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Know me, O Partha, as the eternal seed of all beings; I am the understanding of the wise, the splendor of the splendid.

7.11 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

I am the strength of the strong, free of desire and passion; in beings I am desire that does not conflict with dharma, O chief of the Bharatas.

7.12 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Whatever states there are—of sattva, of rajas, or of tamas—know them all to come from me; yet I am not in them, but they are in me.

7.13 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Deluded by these three states made of the gunas, this whole world does not know me, who am above them and imperishable.

7.14 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

For this divine maya of mine, made of the gunas, is hard to cross; but those who take refuge in me alone pass beyond this maya.

7.15 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

The evildoers, the deluded, the lowest of men, their knowledge stripped away by maya, given over to a demonic nature, do not take refuge in me.

7.16 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Four kinds of those who do good worship me, Arjuna: the distressed, the seeker of knowledge, the seeker of gain, and the wise, O best of the Bharatas.

7.17 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Of these, the wise one, ever disciplined, devoted to the one alone, stands highest; for to the wise I am exceedingly dear, and he is dear to me.

7.18 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

All of these are noble, but the wise one I hold to be my very self; for, steady in himself, he is set on me alone as the highest goal.

7.19 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

At the end of many births the wise one comes to me, knowing that Vasudeva is all; such a great soul is very rare.

7.20 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Those whose knowledge is carried off by this or that desire take refuge in other gods, following this and that observance, constrained by their own nature.

7.21 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Whatever form a devotee seeks to worship with faith, it is I who make that faith of his steady.

7.22 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Yoked with that faith, he seeks to honor that form, and from it obtains his desires—though it is I alone who grant them.

7.23 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

But the fruit won by these small-minded ones is finite; those who worship the gods go to the gods, while those devoted to me come to me.

7.24 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

The unwise take me, the unmanifest, to have come into manifest being, not knowing my higher nature, imperishable and supreme.

7.25 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Veiled by my yoga-maya, I am not manifest to all; this deluded world does not know me, the unborn and imperishable.

7.26 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

I know the beings that are past, that are present, and that are to come, O Arjuna; but no one knows me.

7.27 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

By the delusion of the pairs of opposites, sprung from desire and aversion, O Bharata, all beings fall into bewilderment at birth, O scorcher of foes.

7.28 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

But those of pure deeds, whose sins have ended, freed from the delusion of the pairs of opposites, worship me with firm resolve.

7.29 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Those who, taking refuge in me, strive for release from old age and death know that Brahman, the whole inner principle, and the whole of action.

7.30 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Those who know me together with the material domain, the divine principle, and the sacrificial principle, their minds yoked, know me even at the hour of death.

Chapter 8 - Akshara-Brahma Yoga

8.1 (*Arjuna*)

What is that Brahman? What is the inner principle? What is action, O Purushottama? What is called the material domain, and what the divine principle?

8.2 (*Arjuna*)

Who, and how, is the sacrificial principle here in this body, O Madhusudana? And how, at the hour of death, are you to be known by the self-controlled?

8.3 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Brahman is the supreme, the imperishable; one's own essential being is called the inner principle. The creative force that brings beings into existence is called action.

8.4 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

The material domain is perishable existence; the purusha is the divine principle; and the sacrificial principle is I myself, here within the body, O best of the embodied.

8.5 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

And whoever, at the hour of death, remembering me alone, departs, leaving the body, attains my being; of this there is no doubt.

8.6 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Whatever state one calls to mind as he leaves the body at the end, to that very state he goes, O son of Kunti, ever shaped by that thought.

8.7 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Therefore at all times remember me, and fight; with mind and understanding fixed on me, you shall come to me, beyond doubt.

8.8 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

With the mind disciplined by practice and not straying elsewhere, one reaches the supreme divine person, meditating on him, O Partha.

8.9 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Whoever meditates on the ancient seer, the ruler of all, smaller than the small, the sustainer of all, of form beyond thought, sunlike in color, beyond the darkness—

8.10 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

at the hour of departure, with mind unmoving, joined with devotion and the power of yoga, setting the breath rightly between the brows, he reaches that supreme divine person.

8.11 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

That state which the knowers of the Veda call imperishable, which ascetics free of passion enter, and seeking which they live in celibacy—that state I shall declare to you in brief.

8.12 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Closing all the gates, confining the mind in the heart, drawing the breath up into the head, established in the concentration of yoga,

8.13 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

uttering the single syllable Om, which is Brahman, and remembering me, he who departs, leaving the body, reaches the supreme goal.

8.14 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

For the yogin who, undistracted, remembers me constantly, day after day, I am easy to reach, O Partha—for the ever-disciplined one.

8.15 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Having reached me, the great souls are not born again into this fleeting home of sorrow; they have attained the highest perfection.

8.16 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

From the world of Brahma downward, all worlds are subject to return, Arjuna; but having reached me, O son of Kunti, there is no rebirth.

8.17 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Those who know that Brahma's day lasts a thousand ages, and his night ends after a thousand ages—they are the people who know day

and night.

8.18 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

At the coming of day all manifest things arise from the unmanifest; at the coming of night they dissolve into that same unmanifest.

8.19 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

This same host of beings, coming to be again and again, dissolves helplessly at the coming of night, O Partha, and comes forth at the coming of day.

8.20 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

But beyond this unmanifest is another, eternal unmanifest, which does not perish when all beings perish.

8.21 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

This unmanifest, called the imperishable, is named the supreme goal; reaching it, they do not return—that is my supreme abode.

8.22 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

That supreme person, O Partha, in whom all beings dwell and by whom all this is pervaded, is to be reached by undivided devotion.

8.23 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Now I shall tell you, O best of the Bharatas, the time at which yogins who depart go to no return, and the time at which they return.

8.24 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Fire, light, day, the bright fortnight, the six months of the sun's northward course—departing then, those who know Brahman go to Brahman.

8.25 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Smoke, night, the dark fortnight, the six months of the southward course—by these the yogin reaches the lunar light and returns.

8.26 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

These two paths of the world, the bright and the dark, are held to be eternal; by the one a person goes to no return, by the other he returns

again.

8.27 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Knowing these two paths, O Partha, no yogin is deluded; therefore at all times be yoked in yoga, Arjuna.

8.28 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

The yogin who knows all this passes beyond whatever fruit of merit is laid down for the Vedas, for sacrifices, austerities, and gifts, and reaches the supreme, primal abode.

Chapter 9 - Raja-Vidya Raja-Guhya Yoga

9.1 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

To you, who do not cavil, I shall declare this most secret knowledge together with its realization; knowing it, you will be freed from ill.

9.2 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

This is the royal knowledge, the royal secret, the supreme purifier, plain to direct experience, in keeping with dharma, easy to practice, and imperishable.

9.3 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

People who put no faith in this dharma, O scorcher of foes, fail to reach me and return to the path of death and samsara.

9.4 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

By me, in my unmanifest form, this whole world is pervaded; all beings dwell in me, but I do not dwell in them.

9.5 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

And yet beings do not dwell in me—behold my sovereign yoga! Sustaining beings, yet not dwelling in them, my self is what brings beings into being.

9.6 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

As the vast wind, moving everywhere, abides always in space, so, understand, all beings abide in me.

9.7 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

All beings, O son of Kunti, pass into my prakriti at the end of an aeon, and at the aeon's beginning I send them forth again.

9.8 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Resting on my own prakriti, I send forth again and again this whole host of beings, helpless under the sway of prakriti.

9.9 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Nor do these actions bind me, O Dhananjaya; I remain seated apart,

unattached to those actions.

9.10 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Under my oversight, prakriti gives birth to all that moves and does not move; by this cause, O son of Kunti, the world turns round.

9.11 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

The foolish scorn me when I have taken on a human form, not knowing my higher being as the great lord of beings.

9.12 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Their hopes vain, their actions vain, their knowledge vain, bereft of sense, they fall into a deluding, fiendish, and brutish nature.

9.13 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

But the great souls, O Partha, sheltering in the divine nature, worship me with undivided mind, knowing me as the imperishable source of beings.

9.14 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Ever glorifying me, striving with firm vows, bowing before me with devotion, they worship me, ever steadfast.

9.15 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Others, offering the sacrifice of knowledge, worship me as the one, as the many, and as facing in all directions, in my manifold forms.

9.16 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

I am the rite, I am the sacrifice, I am the offering to the ancestors, I am the herb; I am the sacred formula, I am the melted butter, I am the fire, I am the oblation.

9.17 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

I am the father of this world, its mother, sustainer, and forefather; the object of knowledge, the purifier, the syllable Om, and the Rig, the Sama, and the Yajur Veda.

9.18 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

I am the goal, the upholder, the lord, the witness, the dwelling, the

refuge, the friend; the origin, the dissolution, the ground, the resting place, the imperishable seed.

9.19 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

I give heat; I hold back the rain and send it forth; I am immortality and death, being and nonbeing, Arjuna.

9.20 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

The knowers of the three Vedas, who drink the soma and are cleansed of sin, worship me with sacrifices and seek the way to heaven; reaching the holy world of Indra, they taste in heaven the divine pleasures of the gods.

9.21 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Having enjoyed that vast world of heaven, their merit spent, they enter the world of mortals; so, following the dharma of the three Vedas and craving pleasures, they come and go.

9.22 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

But those who, thinking of no other, worship me, ever yoked to me—for them I secure what they lack and preserve what they have.

9.23 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Even those devoted to other gods who worship them with faith, O son of Kunti, worship me too, though not in the appointed way.

9.24 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

For I am the enjoyer and the lord of all sacrifices; but they do not know me in truth, and so they fall.

9.25 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Those who worship the gods go to the gods; those who worship the ancestors go to the ancestors; those who worship the spirits go to the spirits; but those who worship me come to me.

9.26 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Whoever offers me with devotion a leaf, a flower, a fruit, or water—that offering of devotion, given by the pure of heart, I accept.

9.27 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Whatever you do, whatever you eat, whatever you offer or give, whatever austerity you practice, O son of Kunti, do it as an offering to me.

9.28 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

So you will be freed from the bonds of action, from its good and evil fruits; your self yoked in the yoga of renunciation, set free, you will come to me.

9.29 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

I am the same toward all beings; none is hateful to me and none dear; but those who worship me with devotion are in me, and I too am in them.

9.30 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Even one of very evil conduct who worships me, devoted to none else, is to be reckoned among the good, for his resolve is right.

9.31 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Swiftly he becomes righteous of soul and attains lasting peace; know it for certain, O son of Kunti—no one devoted to me is lost.

9.32 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

For those who take refuge in me, O Partha, even if born of a lowly womb—women, vaishyas, and shudras—even they reach the supreme goal.

9.33 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

How much more, then, the pure brahmins and devoted royal sages! Having come to this fleeting, joyless world, worship me.

9.34 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Fix your mind on me, be devoted to me, sacrifice to me, bow before me; so, yoking yourself, with me as your highest goal, you will come to me.

Chapter 10 - Vibhuti Yoga

10.1 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Once more, O mighty-armed one, hear my supreme word, which I shall speak to you, who are dear to me, desiring your good.

10.2 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Neither the hosts of gods nor the great sages know my origin; for I am the source of the gods and of the great sages in every way.

10.3 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

He who knows me as unborn and beginningless, the great lord of the worlds, is undeluded among mortals and freed from all sins.

10.4 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Understanding, knowledge, freedom from delusion, patience, truth, self-restraint, and calm; pleasure and pain, becoming and passing away, fear and fearlessness;

10.5 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

nonviolence, evenness, contentment, austerity, charity, fame and disrepute—these varied states of beings arise from me alone.

10.6 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

The seven great sages of old, and the four Manus too, sharing my nature, were born of my mind; from them sprang these creatures of the world.

10.7 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

He who knows in truth this glory and yoga of mine is yoked with unshaken yoga; of this there is no doubt.

10.8 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

I am the origin of all; from me everything proceeds. Knowing this, the wise, filled with feeling, worship me.

10.9 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Their minds set on me, their lives given over to me, enlightening one

another and ever speaking of me, they are content and glad.

10.10 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

To these, ever yoked to me and worshipping me with love, I give that yoga of understanding by which they come to me.

10.11 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Out of compassion for them, dwelling within their hearts, I destroy the darkness born of ignorance with the shining lamp of knowledge.

10.12 (*Arjuna*)

You are the supreme Brahman, the supreme abode, the supreme purifier; the eternal divine person, the primal god, unborn and all-pervading.

10.13 (*Arjuna*)

So all the sages declare you—the divine seer Narada, Asita, Devala, and Vyasa—and you yourself tell me so.

10.14 (*Arjuna*)

I hold all this that you tell me to be true, O Keshava; for neither the gods nor the danavas know your manifestation, O Bhagavan.

10.15 (*Arjuna*)

You alone know yourself by yourself, O Purushottama—source of beings, lord of beings, god of gods, lord of the world.

10.16 (*Arjuna*)

Tell me, then, in full, of your divine glories, by which you pervade these worlds and abide in them.

10.17 (*Arjuna*)

How shall I know you, O yogin, by constant meditation? In what forms, O Bhagavan, are you to be contemplated by me?

10.18 (*Arjuna*)

Tell me again, in detail, O Janardana, of your yoga and your glories; for I am not sated with hearing this nectar.

10.19 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

So be it: I shall tell you of my divine glories—but only the chief of them, O best of the Kurus, for there is no end to my extent.

10.20 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

I am the true Self (Atman), O Gudakesha, seated in the heart of all beings; I am the beginning, the middle, and the end of beings.

10.21 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Among the Adityas I am Vishnu; among lights, the radiant sun; among the Maruts I am Marichi; among the stars, the moon.

10.22 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Among the Vedas I am the Sama Veda; among the gods, Vasava; among the senses I am the mind; in beings I am consciousness.

10.23 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Among the Rudras I am Shankara; among the yakshas and rakshasas, the lord of wealth; among the Vasus I am fire; among mountains, Meru.

10.24 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Among household priests, O Partha, know me to be their chief, Brihaspati; among generals I am Skanda; among waters, the ocean.

10.25 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Among the great sages I am Bhrigu; among utterances, the single syllable Om; among sacrifices, the sacrifice of silent repetition; among the unmoving, the Himalaya.

10.26 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Among all trees I am the ashvattha; among divine sages, Narada; among the gandharvas, Chitraratha; among the perfected, the sage Kapila.

10.27 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Know me, among horses, as Uchchaihshravas, born of the nectar; among lordly elephants, Airavata; and among men, the king.

10.28 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Among weapons I am the thunderbolt; among cows, the wish-granting cow; among begetters I am Kandarpa; among serpents, Vasuki.

10.29 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Among the nagas I am Ananta; among water-dwellers, Varuna; among the ancestors, Aryaman; among those who govern, Yama.

10.30 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Among the daityas I am Prahlada; among reckoners, time itself; among beasts I am the lion, and among birds, Garuda.

10.31 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Among purifiers I am the wind; among warriors, Rama; among fishes I am the makara, and among rivers, the Ganges.

10.32 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Of creations I am the beginning, the end, and the middle, Arjuna; of branches of knowledge, the knowledge of the self; among debaters, I am the reasoned argument.

10.33 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Of letters I am the letter A; of compounds, the dual; I am imperishable time, and the sustainer facing in every direction.

10.34 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

I am all-devouring death, and the origin of things to come; among feminine powers I am fame, fortune, speech, memory, wisdom, steadfastness, and patience.

10.35 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Of the Sama chants I am the Brihat-sama; of meters, the Gayatri; of months I am Margashirsha; of seasons, the flowering spring.

10.36 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

I am the gambling of the deceitful and the splendor of the splendid; I am victory, I am resolve, I am the sattva of the good.

10.37 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Among the Vrishnis I am Vasudeva; among the Pandavas, Dhananjaya; among sages I am Vyasa; among seers, Ushanas the seer.

10.38 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Among those who chastise I am the rod; among those who seek victory, statecraft; among secrets I am silence; and I am the knowledge of the knowing.

10.39 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

And I am the seed of all beings, Arjuna; there is nothing moving or unmoving that could exist without me.

10.40 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

There is no end to my divine glories, O scorcher of foes; what I have declared of my extent is but a glimpse of it.

10.41 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Whatever being is glorious, prosperous, or mighty, know that it springs from a fragment of my splendor.

10.42 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

But what need have you to know all this in detail, Arjuna? I stand supporting this whole world with a single fragment of myself.

Chapter 11 - Vishvarupa-Darshana Yoga

11.1 (*Arjuna*)

Out of grace toward me you have spoken the supreme secret known as the teaching of the self; by it this delusion of mine is dispelled.

11.2 (*Arjuna*)

For I have heard from you in full of the coming-to-be and passing-away of beings, O lotus-eyed one, and of your imperishable majesty.

11.3 (*Arjuna*)

As you describe yourself, O supreme lord, even so I long to see your sovereign form, O Purushottama.

11.4 (*Arjuna*)

If you think it can be seen by me, O lord, then show me your imperishable self, O lord of yoga.

11.5 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Behold, O Partha, my forms by the hundreds and thousands, of many kinds, divine, of many colors and shapes.

11.6 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

See the Adityas, the Vasus, the Rudras, the two Ashvins, and the Maruts; see many wonders never seen before, O Bharata.

11.7 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

See now, gathered here in one place, the whole world, moving and unmoving, within my body, O Gudakesha, and whatever else you wish to see.

11.8 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

But you cannot see me with this, your own eye; I give you a divine eye—behold my sovereign yoga.

11.9 (*Sanjaya*)

Having spoken thus, O king, Hari, the great lord of yoga, then showed Partha his supreme sovereign form:

11.10 (*Sanjaya*)

with many mouths and eyes, with many wondrous aspects, with many divine ornaments, and many divine weapons raised on high;

11.11 (*Sanjaya*)

wearing divine garlands and garments, anointed with divine perfumes, all-wondrous, resplendent, boundless, with faces on every side.

11.12 (*Sanjaya*)

If the light of a thousand suns were to blaze forth at once in the sky, it might resemble the splendor of that great being.

11.13 (*Sanjaya*)

There the Pandava saw the whole world in its manifold divisions, gathered together in one place, in the body of the god of gods.

11.14 (*Sanjaya*)

Then Dhananjaya, filled with wonder, his hair standing on end, bowed his head before the god and, with joined palms, spoke:

11.15 (*Arjuna*)

I see all the gods in your body, O god, and the various hosts of beings—Brahma the lord seated on the lotus, the seers, and the divine serpents.

11.16 (*Arjuna*)

I see you with countless arms, bellies, mouths, and eyes, endless on every side; I see in you no end, no middle, no beginning, O lord of all, O universal form.

11.17 (*Arjuna*)

I see you with crown, mace, and discus, a mass of radiance blazing on every side, hard to look upon, immeasurable, like the flaming fire and the sun.

11.18 (*Arjuna*)

You are the imperishable, the supreme to be known; you are the ultimate resting place of this universe; you are the undying guardian of

eternal dharma; you, I hold, are the everlasting person.

11.19 (*Arjuna*)

I see you without beginning, middle, or end, of boundless power, with countless arms, the moon and sun your eyes, your face a blazing fire, scorching this whole universe with your radiance.

11.20 (*Arjuna*)

For this space between heaven and earth, and all the quarters, is pervaded by you alone; seeing this wondrous, terrible form of yours, the three worlds tremble, O great soul.

11.21 (*Arjuna*)

Into you these hosts of gods are entering; some, in fear, with folded hands, praise you; the hosts of great seers and the perfected, crying ‘all hail,’ extol you with abundant hymns.

11.22 (*Arjuna*)

The Rudras, Adityas, Vasus, and Sadhyas, the Vishvedevas, the two Ashvins, the Maruts, and the ancestors, the hosts of gandharvas, yakshas, asuras, and the perfected— all gaze upon you in amazement.

11.23 (*Arjuna*)

Seeing your great form, O mighty-armed one, with its many mouths and eyes, its many arms, thighs, and feet, its many bellies, and terrible with many fangs— the worlds tremble, and so do I.

11.24 (*Arjuna*)

Seeing you touch the sky, ablaze with many colors, your mouths gaping, your great eyes aflame, my inmost self trembles, O Vishnu; I find neither steadiness nor peace.

11.25 (*Arjuna*)

Seeing your mouths, terrible with fangs, like the fire at the world’s end, I lose all sense of direction and find no refuge; be gracious, O lord of the gods, O dwelling of the world.

11.26 (*Arjuna*)

And all these sons of Dhritarashtra, along with the throng of kings—Bhishma, Drona, and that son of a charioteer too, together with the chief warriors on our side—

11.27 (*Arjuna*)

rush into your mouths, fearsome with fangs; some are seen with their heads crushed, caught between your teeth.

11.28 (*Arjuna*)

As the many torrents of rivers rush toward the sea, so these heroes of the human world enter your blazing mouths.

11.29 (*Arjuna*)

As moths fly headlong into a blazing flame to their destruction, so do these worlds rush headlong into your mouths to their destruction.

11.30 (*Arjuna*)

You lick up all the worlds on every side with your flaming mouths, devouring them; your fierce rays fill the whole universe with light and scorch it, O Vishnu.

11.31 (*Arjuna*)

Tell me who you are, so terrible in form. Homage to you, O best of gods; be gracious. I long to know you, the primal one, for I do not comprehend your working.

11.32 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

I am time, grown mighty, the destroyer of the worlds, here at work to gather the worlds in. Even without you, the warriors arrayed in the opposing ranks shall all cease to be.

11.33 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Therefore rise up and win glory; conquer your foes and enjoy a flourishing kingdom. By me they are already slain; be only the instrument, O Savyasachin.

11.34 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Drona, Bhishma, Jayadratha, Karna, and the other warrior-heroes as

well— slay them, already slain by me; do not waver. Fight! You will conquer your rivals in battle.

11.35 (*Sanjaya*)

Hearing these words of Keshava, the diademed one, trembling, with folded hands, bowed again to Krishna and, faltering and terrified, prostrate, spoke once more:

11.36 (*Arjuna*)

Rightly, O Hrishikesh, does the world rejoice and delight in your praise; the rakshasas flee in terror in every direction, and all the hosts of the perfected bow down.

11.37 (*Arjuna*)

And why should they not bow to you, O great soul, greater even than Brahma, the first creator? O boundless one, lord of the gods, dwelling of the world, you are the imperishable—being, nonbeing, and what is beyond both.

11.38 (*Arjuna*)

You are the primal god, the ancient person, the supreme resting place of this universe; you are the knower and the known, the highest abode; by you the universe is pervaded, O you of endless forms.

11.39 (*Arjuna*)

You are Vayu, Yama, Agni, Varuna, the moon, Prajapati, and the great-grandsire; homage to you a thousandfold, and again and again, homage, homage to you.

11.40 (*Arjuna*)

Homage to you before and behind, homage to you on every side, O all; boundless in power and measureless in might, you encompass all, and so you are all.

11.41 (*Arjuna*)

Thinking you a friend, I addressed you rashly—‘Krishna! Yadava! my friend!’—not knowing this greatness of yours, through heedlessness or through love.

11.42 (*Arjuna*)

And if, in jest, I slighted you while at play, resting, sitting, or at meals, alone or before others, O Acyuta, I beg your forgiveness, O immeasurable one.

11.43 (*Arjuna*)

You are the father of this world, moving and unmoving, its object of worship and most venerable teacher; there is none equal to you—how then a greater?—O unrivaled in power in the three worlds.

11.44 (*Arjuna*)

Therefore, bowing low and prostrating my body, I beg your grace, O lord worthy of praise; as a father with a son, a friend with a friend, a lover with the beloved, bear with me, O god.

11.45 (*Arjuna*)

Glad am I to have seen what was never seen before, yet my mind trembles with fear; show me, O god, that very form again; be gracious, O lord of the gods, O dwelling of the world.

11.46 (*Arjuna*)

I wish to see you as before, crowned, bearing mace and discus in hand; take on again that four-armed form, O thousand-armed one, O universal form.

11.47 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Out of grace toward you, Arjuna, by my own yoga I have shown you this supreme form—radiant, universal, boundless, primeval—which none but you has ever seen.

11.48 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Not by the Vedas and sacrifices, not by study, gifts, rites, or severe austerities can I be seen in this form in the world of men by any but you, O foremost of the Kurus.

11.49 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Do not tremble, do not be bewildered, at seeing this terrible form of mine; with fear gone and glad heart, behold once more this very form

of mine.

11.50 (*Sanjaya*)

Having spoken thus to Arjuna, Vasudeva showed his own form again; and the great soul, taking on once more his gentle shape, comforted the terrified one.

11.51 (*Arjuna*)

Seeing your gentle human form again, O Janardana, I have come to my senses and returned to my own nature.

11.52 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

This form of mine that you have seen is very hard to behold; even the gods long forever to see this form.

11.53 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Not by the Vedas, nor by austerity, nor by gifts, nor by sacrifice can I be seen in the form in which you have seen me.

11.54 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

But by undivided devotion, O Arjuna, I can be known, and seen, and truly entered into, O scorcher of foes.

11.55 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

He who does his work for me, who holds me as the highest, devoted to me, free of attachment, without enmity toward any being—he comes to me, O Pandava.

Chapter 12 - Bhakti Yoga

12.1 (*Arjuna*)

Those devotees who, ever steadfast, worship you, and those who worship the imperishable and unmanifest—which of them better know yoga?

12.2 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Those who fix their minds on me and, ever steadfast, worship me with supreme faith—they I hold to be the most perfect in yoga.

12.3 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

But those who worship the imperishable, the undefinable, the unmanifest, all-pervading and unthinkable, unchanging, fixed, and still—

12.4 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

having restrained the whole set of senses, even-minded in all circumstances, rejoicing in the welfare of all beings—they too attain me.

12.5 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Greater is the toil of those whose minds are set on the unmanifest; for the unmanifest goal is hard for the embodied to reach.

12.6 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

But those who, surrendering all actions to me, intent on me, worship me, meditating with undivided yoga,

12.7 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

For them, whose minds are absorbed in me, I soon become the deliverer from the ocean of death and samsara, O Partha.

12.8 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Fix your mind on me alone, rest your understanding in me; thereafter you will dwell in me alone—of this there is no doubt.

12.9 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

But if you cannot fix your mind steadily on me, then seek to reach me by the yoga of practice, O Dhananjaya.

12.10 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

If you are unable even to practice, be intent on working for me; doing your actions for my sake, you too will attain perfection.

12.11 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

And if even this you cannot do, then, taking refuge in my yoga, with self subdued, give up the fruit of all action.

12.12 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Knowledge is better than practice; meditation surpasses knowledge; better than meditation is the renouncing of the fruits of action—from such renouncing, peace follows at once.

12.13 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

He who hates no being, who is friendly and compassionate, free of possessiveness and ego, even in pain and pleasure, and forgiving;

12.14 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

ever content, the yogin self-controlled, of firm resolve, his mind and understanding given to me—he who is devoted to me is dear to me.

12.15 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

He from whom the world is not disturbed, and who is not disturbed by the world, who is free from joy, resentment, fear, and agitation—he is dear to me.

12.16 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

He who is not dependent on anything, pure, capable, impartial, and untroubled, who has renounced all undertakings—that devotee of mine is dear to me.

12.17 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

He who neither rejoices nor hates, neither grieves nor longs, who has given up concern with good and bad outcomes—that devotee of mine is dear to me.

12.18 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

The same to foe and friend, the same in honor and dishonor, the same

in cold and heat, in pleasure and pain, free of attachment;

12.19 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

weighing blame and praise alike, silent, content with whatever comes, without a fixed home, steady of mind, full of devotion—such a person is dear to me.

12.20 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

But those who honor this nectar of dharma, as I have told it, full of faith and holding me as the highest—those devotees are exceedingly dear to me.

Chapter 13 - Kshetra-Kshetrajna Vibhaga Yoga

13.1 (*Arjuna*)

I wish to know prakriti and purusha, the field and the knower of the field, and knowledge and what is to be known, O Keshava.

13.2 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

This body, O son of Kunti, is called the field; and the one who knows it, those who know call the knower of the field.

13.3 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Know me too, O Bharata, as the knower of the field in all fields; and the knowledge of the field and its knower—that, I hold, is true knowledge.

13.4 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

What that field is, of what kind, with what changes, whence it arises, and who he is and what his powers are—hear this from me in brief.

13.5 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

This has been sung by seers in many ways, in various hymns, and in the well-reasoned, definitive words of the aphorisms on Brahman.

13.6 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

The great elements, the ego, the understanding, and the unmanifest; the ten senses and the one mind, and the five fields of sense;

13.7 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

desire and aversion, pleasure and pain, the bodily whole, awareness, and steadfastness—this, in brief, is the field together with its changes.

13.8 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Humility, sincerity, nonviolence, patience, uprightness, service to the teacher, purity, steadiness, and self-restraint;

13.9 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

indifference to the objects of sense, absence of ego, and a clear sight of the evil in birth, death, old age, sickness, and pain;

13.10 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

non-attachment, freedom from clinging to son, wife, home, and the rest, and a constant evenness of mind toward the welcome and the unwelcome;

13.11 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

unswerving devotion to me through undistracted yoga, resort to secluded places, and no delight in crowds of people;

13.12 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

constancy in knowledge of the self and insight into the aim of true knowledge—this is declared to be knowledge; what differs from it is ignorance.

13.13 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

I shall declare what is to be known, knowing which one gains the deathless: the beginningless supreme Brahman, said to be neither being nor nonbeing.

13.14 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

With hands and feet on every side, with eyes, heads, and faces on every side, with ears on every side, it abides, enfolding all in the world.

13.15 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Shining through the powers of all the senses, yet free of all the senses; unattached, yet bearing all; without gunas, yet enjoying the gunas;

13.16 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

outside and inside all beings; unmoving, yet moving; too subtle to be known; far away, and yet near.

13.17 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Undivided, yet seeming divided among beings; this is to be known as the sustainer of beings, their devourer and their source.

13.18 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

It is the light even of lights, said to be beyond darkness; it is knowledge, the object of knowledge, to be reached by knowledge, seated in the

hearts of all.

13.19 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Thus the field, knowledge, and the knowable have been told in brief; one devoted to me, knowing this, becomes fit for my being.

13.20 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Know that both prakriti and purusha are without beginning; and know that the changes and the gunas are born of prakriti.

13.21 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Prakriti is said to be the cause in the working of cause and effect; purusha is said to be the cause in the experiencing of pleasure and pain.

13.22 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

For purusha, seated in prakriti, experiences the gunas born of prakriti; attachment to the gunas is the cause of its birth in good and evil wombs.

13.23 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

The supreme purusha in this body is also called the witness, the consentor, the bearer, the experiencer, the great lord, and the supreme Atman.

13.24 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

He who thus knows purusha and prakriti, together with the gunas, in whatever state he lives, is not born again.

13.25 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Some, by meditation, see the self in the self by the self; others by the yoga of Sankhya, and others by the yoga of action.

13.26 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Others, not knowing this, worship having heard it from others; they too, devoted to what they hear, cross beyond death.

13.27 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Whatever being is born, moving or unmoving, know it to arise from

the union of kshetra and kshetrajna, O best of the Bharatas.

13.28 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

He who sees the supreme lord dwelling alike in all beings, undying amid the dying, truly sees.

13.29 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

For seeing the lord present the same everywhere, he does not harm the self by the self, and so reaches the supreme goal.

13.30 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

He who sees that actions are performed in every way by prakriti alone, and that the self is not the doer, truly sees.

13.31 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

When he sees the separate states of beings as resting in the One, and their spreading forth from that alone, then he attains Brahman.

13.32 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Beginningless and without gunas, this supreme self, imperishable, though seated in the body, O son of Kunti, neither acts nor is tainted.

13.33 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

As all-pervading space, being subtle, is not tainted, so the self, seated everywhere in the body, is not tainted.

13.34 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

As the one sun lights up this whole world, so the knower of the field lights up the whole field, O Bharata.

13.35 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Those who, with the eye of knowledge, thus discern the difference between kshetra and kshetrajna, and the freeing of beings from prakriti, reach the Supreme.

Chapter 14 - Guna-Traya Vibhaga Yoga

14.1 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

I shall declare again the supreme knowledge, the best of all knowledge, by knowing which all the sages have passed from here to the highest perfection.

14.2 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Taking refuge in this knowledge, they come to share my nature; they are not born at creation, nor troubled at dissolution.

14.3 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

The great Brahman is my womb; in it I place the seed, and from it, O Bharata, comes the birth of all beings.

14.4 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Whatever forms take birth in all wombs, O son of Kunti, the great Brahman is their womb, and I am the father who gives the seed.

14.5 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Sattva, rajas, and tamas—the gunas born of prakriti—bind fast in the body, O mighty-armed one, the imperishable embodied one.

14.6 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Of these, sattva, being pure, is luminous and free of ill; it binds, O blameless one, by attachment to happiness and to knowledge.

14.7 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Know rajas to be of the nature of passion, born of craving and attachment; it binds the embodied one, O son of Kunti, by attachment to action.

14.8 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

But know tamas, born of ignorance, to delude all embodied beings; it binds them by carelessness, sloth, and sleep, O Bharata.

14.9 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Sattva binds one to happiness, rajas to action, O Bharata; but tamas,

veiling knowledge, binds one to carelessness.

14.10 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Sattva prevails by mastering rajas and tamas, O Bharata; rajas, by mastering sattva and tamas; and tamas likewise, by mastering sattva and rajas.

14.11 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

When the light of knowledge shines forth through all the gates of this body, then one should know that sattva has grown strong.

14.12 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Greed, busy activity, the undertaking of works, restlessness, and longing—these arise when rajas has grown strong, O best of the Bharatas.

14.13 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Darkness, inertia, carelessness, and mere delusion—these arise when tamas has grown strong, O joy of the Kurus.

14.14 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

When the embodied one meets death while sattva prevails, he attains the spotless worlds of those who know the highest.

14.15 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Meeting death in rajas, he is born among those attached to action; and dying in tamas, he is born in the wombs of the deluded.

14.16 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

The fruit of good action, they say, is of the nature of sattva and untainted; but the fruit of rajas is pain, and the fruit of tamas is ignorance.

14.17 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

From sattva is born knowledge, from rajas greed, and from tamas come carelessness, delusion, and ignorance.

14.18 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Those settled in sattva rise upward; those in rajas stay in the middle;

those in tamas, settled in the lowest disposition, sink downward.

14.19 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

When the seer perceives no doer other than the gunas, and knows what is beyond the gunas, he attains my being.

14.20 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Passing beyond these three gunas, which are the source of the body, the embodied one is freed from birth, death, old age, and sorrow, and attains the deathless.

14.21 (*Arjuna*)

By what marks is the one who has passed beyond these three gunas known, O lord? How does he act, and how does he cross beyond these three gunas?

14.22 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

He neither shuns light, activity, or delusion when they come, O Pandava, nor longs for them when they go;

14.23 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

seated apart, as it were, unmoved by the gunas, he stands firm and does not waver, knowing that it is only the gunas at work;

14.24 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

alike in pain and pleasure, self-possessed, holding clod, stone, and gold as one, the same toward the dear and the unwelcome, steadfast, the same under blame and praise;

14.25 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

the same in honor and dishonor, the same toward friend and foe, giving up all undertakings—he is said to have gone beyond the gunas.

14.26 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

And he who serves me with unswerving devotion, passing beyond these gunas, becomes fit to become Brahman.

14.27 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

For I am the ground of Brahman, of the deathless and imperishable, of

eternal dharma, and of absolute bliss.

Chapter 15 - Purushottama Yoga

15.1 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

They speak of an imperishable ashvattha tree, its roots above and branches below, whose leaves are the hymns; he who knows it knows the Vedas.

15.2 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Its branches spread below and above, nourished by the gunas, with the objects of sense for buds; and below, its roots stretch on, binding to action in the world of men.

15.3 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Its form is not perceived here as it is—no end, no beginning, no resting place. Having cut down this firm-rooted ashvattha with the strong axe of non-attachment,

15.4 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

one must then seek that place from which, having gone, none return again. ‘I take refuge in that primal person, from whom the ancient unfolding streamed forth.’

15.5 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Free of pride and delusion, the fault of attachment conquered, ever dwelling in the self, desire stilled, released from the pairs of opposites known as pleasure and pain, the undeluded reach that imperishable place.

15.6 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Neither sun nor moon nor fire lights up that place; having gone there, they do not return—that is my supreme abode.

15.7 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

A portion of myself, become an eternal living soul in the world of the living, draws to itself the senses, with the mind as the sixth, that rest in prakriti.

15.8 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

When it takes on a body, and when it departs from one, it carries these along, as the wind carries scents from their places.

15.9 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Presiding over hearing, sight, touch, taste, and smell, and over the mind, it experiences the objects of sense.

15.10 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

The deluded do not see it as it departs, abides, or experiences, joined with the gunas; those with the eye of knowledge see it.

15.11 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

The yogins who strive see it seated in the self; but the witless, their selves untrained, do not see it, even though they strive.

15.12 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

The light that dwells in the sun and lights up the whole world, and that which is in the moon and in fire—know that light to be mine.

15.13 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

And entering the earth, I uphold all beings by my power; becoming the moon, full of sap, I nourish all the plants.

15.14 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Becoming the fire of digestion, dwelling in the bodies of living beings, joined with the inward and outward breaths, I digest the four kinds of food.

15.15 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

I am seated in the heart of all; from me come memory, knowledge, and their loss; I am what is to be known through all the Vedas; I am the author of the Vedanta and the knower of the Vedas.

15.16 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

There are two persons in the world, the perishable and the imperishable: the perishable is all beings, the unchanging is called the imperishable.

15.17 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

But there is another, the supreme person, called the supreme Atman,

the imperishable lord who enters the three worlds and sustains them.

15.18 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Since I surpass the perishable and am higher even than the imperishable, I am renowned in the world and in the Vedas as Purushottama, the supreme person.

15.19 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

He who, undeluded, thus knows me as the supreme person knows all; he worships me with his whole being, O Bharata.

15.20 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Thus I have taught you this most secret teaching, O blameless one; knowing it, one becomes wise, his task accomplished, O Bharata.

Chapter 16 - Daivasura-Sampad Vibhaga Yoga

16.1 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Fearlessness, purity of heart, steadfastness in the yoga of knowledge, charity, self-restraint, sacrifice, study of scripture, austerity, and uprightness;

16.2 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

nonviolence, truth, freedom from anger, renunciation, calm, freedom from slander, compassion for all beings, freedom from greed, gentleness, modesty, and steadiness;

16.3 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

vigor, patience, fortitude, purity, freedom from malice and from pride—these belong to one born to a divine lot, O Bharata.

16.4 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Hypocrisy, arrogance, conceit, anger, harshness, and ignorance belong, O Partha, to one born to a demonic lot.

16.5 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

The divine lot leads to liberation, the demonic to bondage; do not grieve, O Pandava—you are born to a divine lot.

16.6 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

In this world there are two orders of created beings, the divine and the demonic; the divine has been described at length, now hear from me of the demonic, O Partha.

16.7 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

The demonic do not know either action or its cessation; in them is found neither purity, nor right conduct, nor truth.

16.8 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

They say the world is without truth, without ground, without a lord, arising from no orderly cause, brought about by desire alone.

16.9 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Holding to this view, these lost souls of feeble understanding and cruel deeds rise up as enemies for the ruin of the world.

16.10 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Clinging to insatiable desire, full of hypocrisy, pride, and arrogance, holding false notions through delusion, they act on impure resolves.

16.11 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Given over to measureless cares that end only with death, holding the satisfaction of desires to be the highest, certain that this is all,

16.12 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

bound by a hundred cords of hope, devoted to desire and anger, they strive to amass hoards of wealth, by foul means, for the enjoyment of desires.

16.13 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

“This I have gained today; this longing I shall now fulfill; this is mine, and this wealth too shall be mine;

16.14 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

that foe I have slain, and I shall slay the others too; I am the lord, I am the enjoyer, I am successful, strong, and happy;

16.15 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

I am rich and high-born; who else is equal to me? I will sacrifice, I will give, I will rejoice”—so they say, deluded by ignorance.

16.16 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Led astray by many fancies, caught in the net of delusion, addicted to the enjoyment of desires, they fall into a foul hell.

16.17 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Self-important, stubborn, filled with the pride and intoxication of wealth, they offer sacrifices in name only, with show and contrary to the rules.

16.18 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Clinging to ego, force, insolence, desire, and anger, these spiteful people

hate me in their own and others' bodies.

16.19 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

These haters, cruel and base among men, the worst of the world, I hurl again and again into demonic wombs, into the rounds of samsara.

16.20 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Cast into demonic wombs, birth after birth, the deluded, never reaching me, O son of Kunti, sink from there to the lowest state.

16.21 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Threefold is this gate of hell, ruin of the self: desire, anger, and greed; therefore one should give up these three.

16.22 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Freed from these three gates of darkness, O son of Kunti, a person works for his own good and so reaches the supreme goal.

16.23 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

But he who casts aside the rule of scripture and acts on the urge of desire reaches neither perfection, nor happiness, nor the supreme goal.

16.24 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Therefore let scripture be your measure in deciding what should and should not be done; knowing what the rule of scripture declares, you should act here in the world.

Chapter 17 - Shraddha-Traya Vibhaga Yoga

17.1 (*Arjuna*)

Those who, setting aside the rule of scripture, yet worship with faith—what is their standing, O Krishna? Sattva, rajas, or tamas?

17.2 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

The faith of the embodied is of three kinds, born of their own nature—sattvic, rajasic, and tamasic; hear of it.

17.3 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

The faith of each, O Bharata, accords with his nature; a person is made of faith—as his faith is, so is he.

17.4 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

The sattvic worship the gods; the rajasic, the yakshas and rakshasas; and the others, the tamasic, worship the dead and the hosts of spirits.

17.5 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Those who practice fierce austerities not enjoined by scripture, full of hypocrisy and ego, driven by the force of desire and attachment,

17.6 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

tormenting, in their folly, the cluster of elements within the body, and me too who dwell within—know them to be of demonic resolve.

17.7 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Food, too, dear to each, is of three kinds, and so are sacrifice, austerity, and giving; hear how they differ.

17.8 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Foods that are juicy, smooth, firm, and pleasing to the heart are dear to the sattvic; they foster life, vitality, strength, health, ease, and good cheer.

17.9 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Foods that are bitter, sour, salty, very hot, sharp, harsh, and burning are craved by the rajasic, and bring pain, grief, and sickness.

17.10 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Food that is stale, tasteless, putrid, and left overnight, leavings, and what is unfit for offering, is dear to the tamasic.

17.11 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

The sacrifice offered as enjoined, by those who seek no fruit, their minds settled that it is simply to be done—that is sattvic.

17.12 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

But the sacrifice offered with an eye to its fruit, or for show, know that to be rajasic, O best of the Bharatas.

17.13 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

A sacrifice offered against the rules, with no food distributed, without sacred words, gifts, or faith, they call tamasic.

17.14 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Worship of the gods, the brahmins, teachers, and the wise; purity, uprightness, celibacy, and nonviolence—these are called austerity of the body.

17.15 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Speech that gives no offense, truthful, kindly, and beneficial, and the regular recitation of scripture—this is called austerity of speech.

17.16 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Serenity of mind, gentleness, silence, self-control, and purity of heart—this is called austerity of the mind.

17.17 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

This threefold austerity, practiced with supreme faith by the steadfast who seek no fruit, is called sattvic.

17.18 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Austerity done for the sake of respect, honor, and reverence, or with hypocrisy, is called rajasic here—unsteady and fleeting.

17.19 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Austerity done with deluded obstinacy, by torturing oneself, or to harm another, is called tamasic.

17.20 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

A gift given because it ought to be given, with no thought of return, in the right place and time and to a worthy person, is held to be sattvic.

17.21 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

But a gift given for the sake of return, or with an eye to its fruit, or grudgingly, is held to be rajasic.

17.22 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

A gift given at the wrong place and time, to the unworthy, without respect or with contempt, is called tamasic.

17.23 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Om Tat Sat—this is held to be the threefold designation of Brahman; by it the brahmins, the Vedas, and the sacrifices were ordained of old.

17.24 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Therefore the acts of sacrifice, gift, and austerity prescribed by the rules are always begun with the utterance ‘Om’ by the expounders of Brahman.

17.25 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

With ‘Tat,’ and seeking no fruit, the various acts of sacrifice, austerity, and gift are performed by those who long for liberation.

17.26 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

The word ‘Sat’ is used for what is real and for what is good; and ‘Sat,’ O Partha, is also applied to a praiseworthy act.

17.27 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Steadfastness in sacrifice, austerity, and gift is also called ‘Sat,’ and action for the sake of that is likewise called ‘Sat.’

17.28 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Whatever is offered or given or done as austerity without faith is called ‘Asat,’ O Partha; it counts for nothing, here or hereafter.

Chapter 18 - Moksha-Sannyasa Yoga

18.1 (*Arjuna*)

I wish to know, O mighty-armed one, the truth of renunciation, and of relinquishment as well, each apart, O Hrishikesha, slayer of Keshin.

18.2 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

The giving up of desire-driven actions, the sages call renunciation; the surrender of the fruit of all actions, the discerning call relinquishment.

18.3 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Action should be given up as an evil, say some thoughtful men; others say the acts of sacrifice, gift, and austerity should not be given up.

18.4 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Hear my conclusion on this relinquishment, O best of the Bharatas; for relinquishment, O tiger among men, is declared to be of three kinds.

18.5 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Acts of sacrifice, gift, and austerity should not be given up but performed; for sacrifice, gift, and austerity are purifiers of the wise.

18.6 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Yet even these actions should be done giving up attachment and their fruits; this, O Partha, is my settled and highest conviction.

18.7 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

But the giving up of an enjoined action is not fitting; to abandon it through delusion is held to be tamasic.

18.8 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

He who gives up an action merely as troublesome, fearing bodily pain, performs a rajasic relinquishment and gains no fruit of it.

18.9 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

But when an enjoined action is done simply because it ought to be, O Arjuna, giving up attachment and fruit—that relinquishment is held

sattvic.

18.10 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

The relinquisher filled with sattva, wise and free of doubt, neither shuns disagreeable action nor clings to agreeable action.

18.11 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

For the embodied cannot give up actions entirely; but he who gives up the fruit of action is called a relinquisher.

18.12 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

For those who do not relinquish, the fruit of action after death is threefold—unwanted, wanted, and mixed; but for those who renounce, there is none at all.

18.13 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Learn from me, O mighty-armed one, these five factors, declared in the teaching of Sankhya for the accomplishment of all actions:

18.14 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

the seat of action, the agent, the various instruments, the many and diverse movements, and divine providence as the fifth.

18.15 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Whatever action a person sets in motion with body, speech, or mind, right or wrong, these five are its factors.

18.16 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

That being so, the one who, with untrained understanding, sees the self alone as the agent—that fool does not see truly.

18.17 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

He who is free of the sense of ‘I,’ whose understanding is untainted, though he slay these people, does not slay, and is not bound.

18.18 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Knowledge, the object of knowledge, and the knower—these are the threefold spur to action; the instrument, the act, and the agent—these are the threefold makeup of action.

18.19 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Knowledge, action, and the agent are said, in the reckoning of the gunas, to be of three kinds, by the difference of the gunas; hear of these too, as they are.

18.20 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

The knowledge by which one sees in all beings a single, imperishable being, undivided amid the divided—know that knowledge to be sattvic.

18.21 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

But the knowledge that sees in all beings only manifold separate beings, each apart—know that knowledge to be rajasic.

18.22 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

But the knowledge that clings to one single thing as if it were the whole, without reason, missing the truth, and narrow—that is called tamasic.

18.23 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Action that is enjoined, done without attachment, without craving or aversion, by one who seeks no fruit, is called sattvic.

18.24 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

But action done with great effort by one seeking to satisfy desire, or out of egotism, is called rajasic.

18.25 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Action undertaken through delusion, heedless of its consequence, of loss and harm, and of one's own power, is called tamasic.

18.26 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

An agent free of attachment and ego, possessed of resolve and zeal, unmoved in success and failure, is called sattvic.

18.27 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

An agent driven by passion, craving the fruit of action, greedy, cruel, impure, swept by joy and grief, is called rajasic.

18.28 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

An agent undisciplined, vulgar, stubborn, dishonest, malicious, slothful, despondent, and procrastinating is called tamasic.

18.29 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Now hear, O Dhananjaya, the threefold division of understanding and of resolve, according to the gunas, set out fully and one by one.

18.30 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

The understanding that knows action and renunciation, what is to be done and not done, fear and fearlessness, bondage and liberation, O Partha, is sattvic.

18.31 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

The understanding by which one wrongly grasps dharma and adharma, and what is to be done and not done, O Partha, is rajasic.

18.32 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

The understanding that, wrapped in darkness, takes adharma to be dharma and sees all things inverted, O Partha, is tamasic.

18.33 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

The resolve by which one holds steady the workings of the mind, the breath, and the senses, through unwavering yoga—that resolve, O Partha, is sattvic.

18.34 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

But the resolve by which one clings, with attachment to fruit, to dharma, pleasure, and wealth, longing for their reward, O Partha, is rajasic.

18.35 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

The resolve by which the dull-witted will not let go of sleep, fear, grief, despair, and folly—that resolve, O Partha, is tamasic.

18.36 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Now hear from me, O best of the Bharatas, the threefold happiness, that in which one comes to delight through practice and reaches the end of suffering.

18.37 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

The happiness that is like poison at first but like nectar in the end, born of the serene clarity of one's own understanding, is called sattvic.

18.38 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

The happiness born of the contact of the senses with their objects, like nectar at first but like poison in the end, is held to be rajasic.

18.39 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

The happiness that deludes the self both at first and in the end, arising from sleep, sloth, and heedlessness, is called tamasic.

18.40 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

There is no being, on earth or among the gods in heaven, that is free of these three gunas born of prakriti.

18.41 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

The duties of brahmins, kshatriyas, vaishyas, and shudras, O scorcher of foes, are apportioned by the gunas that arise from their own natures.

18.42 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Calm, restraint, austerity, purity, patience, and uprightness; knowledge, realization, and faith in the unseen—these are the duty of a brahmin, born of his nature.

18.43 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Valor, vigor, fortitude, skill, not fleeing in battle, generosity, and lordly bearing—these are the duty of a kshatriya, born of his nature.

18.44 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Farming, herding, and trade are the duty of a vaishya, born of his nature; and service is the duty of a shudra, born of his nature.

18.45 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Devoted each to his own work, a person attains perfection; hear how one devoted to his own work finds it.

18.46 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

He from whom all beings spring, and by whom all this is pervaded—worshiping him through his own work, a person attains perfection.

18.47 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Better one's own dharma, imperfectly done, than another's dharma well performed; doing the work set by one's own nature, one incurs no fault.

18.48 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

One should not give up the work born of one's nature, O son of Kunti, even if it is flawed; for all undertakings are wrapped in flaw, as fire in smoke.

18.49 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

He whose understanding is unattached everywhere, his self subdued, his longing gone, attains through renunciation the supreme perfection of freedom from action.

18.50 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Hear from me in brief, O son of Kunti, how one who has attained perfection attains Brahman as well—that highest consummation of knowledge.

18.51 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Yoked with a purified understanding, restraining the self with firmness, turning away from sound and the other objects of sense, casting off craving and aversion,

18.52 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

dwelling apart, eating little, his speech, body, and mind controlled, ever absorbed in the yoga of meditation, taking refuge in dispassion,

18.53 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

freed from ego, force, pride, desire, anger, and possession, without a sense of 'mine,' and at peace—he is fit for the state of Brahman.

18.54 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Become Brahman, serene in self, he neither grieves nor craves; the same

toward all beings, he attains supreme devotion to me.

18.55 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

By devotion he comes to know me, who and how great I truly am; and knowing me in truth, he enters into me forthwith.

18.56 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Ever performing all actions, taking refuge in me, by my grace he reaches the eternal, imperishable abode.

18.57 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Surrendering all actions to me in your thought, intent on me, taking refuge in the yoga of understanding, keep your mind ever fixed on me.

18.58 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

With your mind on me, you will cross over all difficulties by my grace; but if through ego you will not listen, you will be lost.

18.59 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

If, relying on your ego, you think, 'I will not fight,' vain is this resolve of yours; your own nature will compel you.

18.60 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Bound by your own work, born of your nature, O son of Kunti, what through delusion you wish not to do, you will do even against your will.

18.61 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

The lord dwells in the heart of all beings, Arjuna, whirling them all about by his maya, as though mounted on a machine.

18.62 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Take refuge in him alone with all your being, O Bharata; by his grace you will attain supreme peace and the eternal abode.

18.63 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Thus I have declared to you the knowledge more secret than all secrets; ponder it fully, and then do as you wish.

18.64 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Hear again my supreme word, the most secret of all; you are greatly loved by me, and so I shall tell you what is for your good.

18.65 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Fix your mind on me, be devoted to me, sacrifice to me, bow before me; so you will come to me. I promise you truly, for you are dear to me.

18.66 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Giving up all dharmas, take refuge in me alone; I will free you from all sins—do not grieve.

18.67 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

This is never to be told by you to one without austerity or devotion, to one who will not listen, or to one who scorns me.

18.68 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

He who shall declare this supreme secret among those devoted to me, offering me the highest devotion, will come to me beyond doubt.

18.69 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Among men there is none who does me dearer service, and there will be no one on earth dearer to me than he.

18.70 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

And he who studies this our dialogue on dharma—by him I shall be worshiped with the sacrifice of knowledge; so I hold.

18.71 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

And the one who merely hears it, full of faith and free of scorn—he too, set free, will attain the happy worlds of those who do right.

18.72 (*Shri Bhagavan Krishna*)

Have you heard this, O Partha, with mind one-pointed? Has your delusion born of ignorance been destroyed, O Dhananjaya?

18.73 (*Arjuna*)

My delusion is gone; by your grace, O Acyuta, I have regained my memory. I stand firm, my doubts dispelled; I will do your word.

18.74 (*Sanjaya*)

Thus have I heard this wondrous dialogue between Vasudeva and the great-souled Partha, making my hair stand on end.

18.75 (*Sanjaya*)

By the grace of Vyasa I have heard this supreme and most secret yoga directly from Krishna, the lord of yoga, as he himself declared it.

18.76 (*Sanjaya*)

O king, recalling again and again this wondrous and holy dialogue of Keshava and Arjuna, I rejoice again and again.

18.77 (*Sanjaya*)

And recalling again and again that most wondrous form of Hari, great is my wonder, O king, and I rejoice again and again.

18.78 (*Sanjaya*)

Wherever Krishna, the lord of yoga, is, and wherever Partha, the archer, is, there, I hold, are fortune, victory, well-being, and steadfast right conduct.

Glossary

Concepts

Atman

True Self, Soul, or inner principle; kept distinct from ordinary ego or individual personality. *Forms: Atman / Ātman*

Brahman

The ultimate reality or absolute principle. *Forms: Brahman / Brahma-nirvana / Brahman-nirvana / Brahma-yoga / Brahma-sūtra / Brahman-realization*

dharma

Order, duty, law, or right conduct; the exact sense depends on context. *Forms: dharma / dharma-field*

guna

A quality or constituent tendency of prakriti: sattva, rajas, and tamas. *Forms: guna / gunas / guṇa / guṇas*

karma

Action, deed, or the consequences bound to action. *Forms: karma / karma-yoga*

kshetra

Field, especially the body or field of experience in Chapter 13. *Forms: kshetra / kṣetra*

kshetrajna

Knower of the field; the conscious principle related to kshetra. *Forms: kshetrajna / kṣetrajña*

maya

Power of appearance, concealment, or manifestation; context-dependent. *Forms: maya / Maya / māyā / Māyā / yoga-maya*

nirvana

Extinction, peace, or release; here often linked with Brahman. *Forms: nirvana / nirvāṇa / Brahma-nirvana / Brahman-nirvana*

prakriti

Nature, material process, or the field of change and manifestation.

Forms: prakriti / Prakriti / prakṛti / Prakṛti

purusha

Person, spirit, or conscious principle; meaning varies by passage.

Forms: purusha / Purusha / puruṣa / Puruṣa

rajas

The guna associated with activity, passion, impulse, and restlessness.

Forms: rajas / rājasika / Rajas / rajasic

samsara

The ongoing cycle of worldly becoming, birth, death, and attachment.

Forms: saṃsāra / samsara

Sankhya

A path or framework of discriminative knowledge; here not always a formal school label. *Forms: Sankhya / Sāṅkhya / Sāṅkhyas / Sāṅkhya-yoga*

Sat

Being, truth, or goodness; in 17.23 part of the sacred formula Om Tat Sat. *Forms: Sat*

sattva

The guna associated with clarity, balance, and illumination. *Forms:*

sattva / sāttvika / Sattva / sattvic

tamas

The guna associated with inertia, dullness, confusion, and obstruction.

Forms: tamas / tāmasika / Tamas / tamasic

Vedanta

The end or culmination of the Vedas; in the text, the knowledge taught by the Vedic tradition. *Forms: Vedanta*

yoga

Discipline, practice, integration, or path toward steadiness and liberation. Literal meaning is "yoking", "uniting", "joining" (from the root yuj: "to yoke", "to unite"). *Forms: yoga / yogī / yogi / karma-yoga / buddhi-yoga / Sāṅkhya-yoga / bhakti-yoga / practice-yoga / yoga-maya*

Social and ritual terms

Brahmin

A member of the priestly or learned class; Sanskrit brāhmaṇa. *Forms:* *Brahmin / brahmin / brāhmaṇa / brāhmaṇas*

kshatriya

Member of the warrior or ruling class. *Forms:* *kshatriya / kṣatriya*

Om

Sacred syllable used as a concise sign of the absolute or divine. *Forms:* *Om / AUM*

shudra

Member of the service class in the traditional varna scheme. *Forms:* *śūdra / śūdras / shudra / shudras*

Tat

Sacred formula meaning 'That', part of the expression Om Tat Sat. *Forms:* *Tat*

vaishya

Member of the class associated with trade, agriculture, and herding. *Forms:* *vaiśya / vaiśyas / vaishya / vaishyas*

Vedas

Ancient sacred texts of the Vedic tradition. *Forms:* *Veda / Vedas / Ṛg / Sāma / Bṛhat-sāma / Gāyatrī / Rig / Yajur / Sama / Gayatri / Brihat-sama*

yajna

Sacrifice, ritual offering, or consecrated action. *Forms:* *yajna / yajña*

Names and epithets

Acyuta

Epithet of Krishna, often glossed as the unfailing one. *Forms:* *Acyuta*

Arjuna

Arjuna, the warrior addressed by Krishna. *Forms:* *Arjuna*

Bhagavan

Honorific title for the Lord or Blessed One, used for Krishna. *Forms:*

Bhagavan

Bharata

A dynastic or ancestral name, often used as an address. *Forms: Bharata / Bhārata / Bharatas / Bhāratas*

Bhima

One of the Pandavas, brother of Arjuna. *Forms: Bhima*

Bhishma

Elder of the Kuru dynasty and leading warrior on the Kaurava side. *Forms: Bhishma*

Brahma

The creator god; distinct from Brahman, the ultimate reality. *Forms: Brahma / Brahma's*

Dhananjaya

Epithet of Arjuna, often understood as winner of wealth. *Forms: Dhananjaya / Dhanañjaya*

Dhritarashtra

The blind king of the Kurus, father of the Kauravas; he opens the dialogue by asking Sanjaya what happened at Kurukshetra. *Forms: Dhritarashtra / Dhritarashtra's*

Draupadi

Wife of the Pandavas. *Forms: Draupadi*

Drona

Teacher of the Kuru princes and warrior on the Kaurava side. *Forms: Drona*

Drupada

King of Panchala, father of Draupadi and Dhrishtadyumna. *Forms: Drupada*

Duryodhana

Leader of the Kauravas and son of Dhritarashtra. *Forms: Duryodhana*

Govinda

Epithet of Krishna. *Forms: Govinda*

Gudakesha

Epithet of Arjuna, commonly linked with mastery over sleep. *Forms: Guḍākeśa / Gudakesha*

Hari

Epithet of Krishna or Vishnu. *Forms: Hari*

Hrishikesha

Epithet of Krishna, often understood as lord of the senses. *Forms: Hr̥ṣīkeśa / Hrishikesha*

Ikshvaku

Ancient king who receives the teaching from Manu. *Forms: Ikshvaku*

Janardana

Epithet of Krishna. *Forms: Janardana / Janārdana*

Karna

Warrior allied with Duryodhana on the Kaurava side. *Forms: Karna*

Kaunteya

Epithet of Arjuna: son of Kunti. *Forms: Kaunteya*

Keshava

Epithet of Krishna. *Forms: Keshava / Keśava*

Krishna

Krishna, speaker of the teaching to Arjuna. *Forms: Krishna / Kṛṣṇa*

Kuru

The Kuru lineage or its members; context may refer to the wider dynasty or the Kaurava side. *Forms: Kuru / Kurus*

Kurukshetra

The battlefield where the dialogue takes place. *Forms: Kurukshetra*

Madhava

Epithet of Krishna. *Forms: Madhava / Mādhava*

Madhusudana

Epithet of Krishna: slayer of Madhu. *Forms: Madhusudana / Madhusūdana*

Manu

Ancient progenitor or lawgiver who receives the teaching from Vivasvan.

Forms: Manu

Pandava

One of the sons or descendants of Pandu; often refers to Arjuna and his brothers. *Forms: Pāṇḍava / Pāṇḍavas / Pandava / Pandavas*

Partha

Epithet of Arjuna: son of Pritha/Kunti. *Forms: Partha / Pārtha*

Prajapati

Lord of creatures; a creator figure. *Forms: Prajapati*

Purushottama

The Supreme Person: epithet of Krishna indicating the supreme reality that transcends both the perishable and the imperishable *Forms: Purushottama*

Sanjaya

Narrator of the dialogue to Dhritarashtra. *Forms: Sanjaya*

Varuna

Vedic deity associated with cosmic order and waters. *Forms: Varuna*

Vasudeva

Name or epithet of Krishna, son of Vasudeva. *Forms: Vāsudeva / Vasudeva*

Vishnu

A divine name associated with Krishna in the text. *Forms: Vishnu*

Vivasvan

Solar deity to whom Krishna says he first taught this yoga. *Forms: Vivasvan*

Yama

Deity associated with death and restraint. *Forms: Yama*